

Figure 5.7 Organizing feature files into folders makes them easier to manage and navigate. In this JBehave project, the features are organized by high-level capability.

Organizing scenarios in terms of features rather than stories makes it easier to generate meaningful living documentation. It can be useful to associate scenarios with the corresponding stories for planning and reporting purposes during an iteration, but the primary association should be between a scenario and the feature it illustrates.

5.5.2 A feature file can contain one or more scenarios

As discussed in chapter 4, you use concrete examples to illustrate each feature. Any example you decide to automate will be represented by a single scenario in the corresponding feature file. As a result, the feature file will contain all of the examples that illustrate its expected behavior. These examples illustrate not only the simple cases but also alternative paths and edge cases that flesh out how the feature behaves in different situations.

5.5.3 Organizing the feature files

When you start to get a large number of feature files in your project, it's important to keep them organized in a way that makes them easy to find and browse. A good way to do this is to place them into subdirectories, as illustrated in figure 5.7. Of course, you'll need to decide what directory structure makes the most sense for your team. In my experience, if you've organized your features in terms of capabilities, as described in chapters 3 and 4, it's very natural to create a directory for each capability.

As you'll see later on, the Thucydides reporting tool (http://www.thucydides.info) can be configured to use this directory structure to group executable requirements by features, capabilities, tags, and so forth.